

CONSTRUCTED REALITIES

Decoding Gender and Sexuality Across Time



THE MISSION



**DECODE THE HISTORICAL ROOTS OF
OUR UNDERSTANDING OF GENDER AND
SEXUALITY.**



**ANALYZE HOW THIS EVOLVING
UNDERSTANDING HAS SYSTEMATICALLY
AFFECTED VARIOUS ASPECTS OF
HUMAN LIFE.**

SYSTEM CHECK (PRE-TEST)

Is patriarchy a biological inevitability or a social construct?

What is the actual definition of feminism beyond internet stereotypes?

Have men always been the dominant figures in human history?
(Hint: Think prehistoric).

THE PARADIGM SPLIT

PATRIARCHY

- **Origin text:** From Greek “Patriarkhes” (Rule of the father).
- **Definition text:** A social system where men primarily hold power in political and private spheres.
- **Mechanism text:** Upholds male supremacy in law, home, workplace, and society. Expects men to lead and women to obey/manage the home. Patrilineal inheritance.

FEMINISM

- **Origin text:** A response to systemic oppression.
- **Definition text:** A continuing series of social movements aiming to challenge patriarchal society.
- **Mechanism text:** Dismantles oppressive political structures, beliefs, and practices against women to demand true equality.

THE ORIGINAL BASELINE: EGALITARIANISM

The Prehistoric Reality:
History proves that prehistoric hunter-gatherer tribes prioritized equality among all members. Men and women contributed equally and enjoyed the same social status.

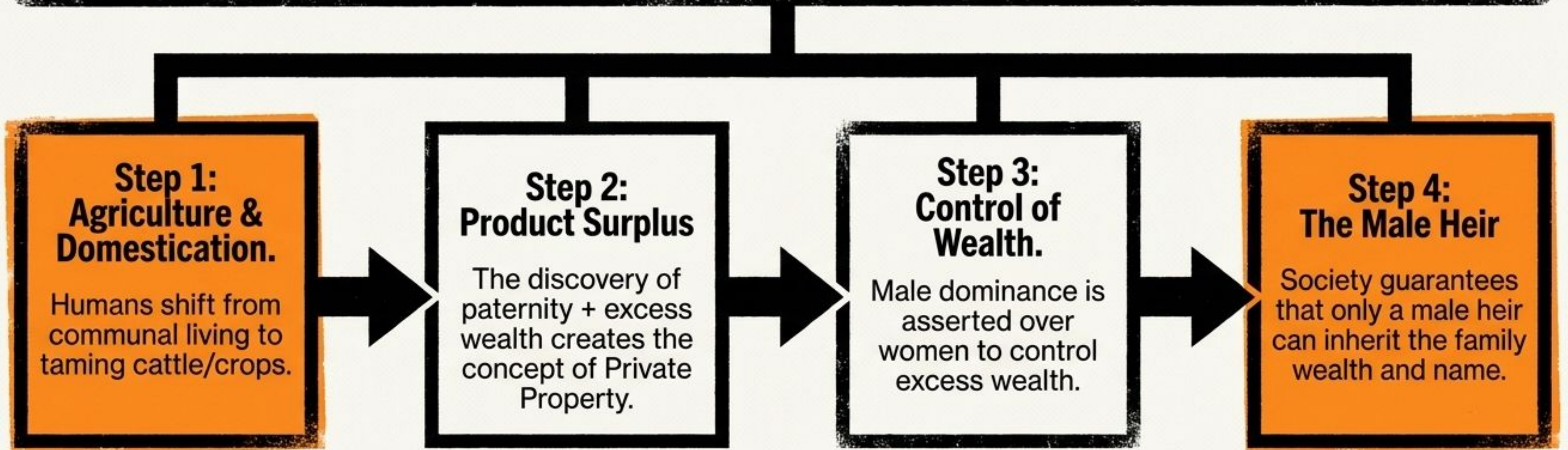


The Divine Feminine: At the dawn of civilization, human societies held women in high regard. The sacredness of women (due to the ability to conceive) meant equitable power and roles.

Inequality is not biological. Equality was our default.

THE INVENTION OF PATRIARCHY

**[Surplus Wealth] + [Need for Control]
= [The Patrilineal Heir]**



ANCIENT WORLD SNAPSHOT



GREECE (The Restrictive Philosophers)

Aristotle & Plato viewed women as the inferior sex and property of men. Forbidden to learn philosophy, politics, or science.
Job: obey, bear children, household.



EGYPT (The Egalitarian Exception)

Herodotus observed Egyptian women enjoyed higher status than Greek women. They could inherit property, engage in trade, and participate in politics. (Until Greek influence spread via Alexander the Great).

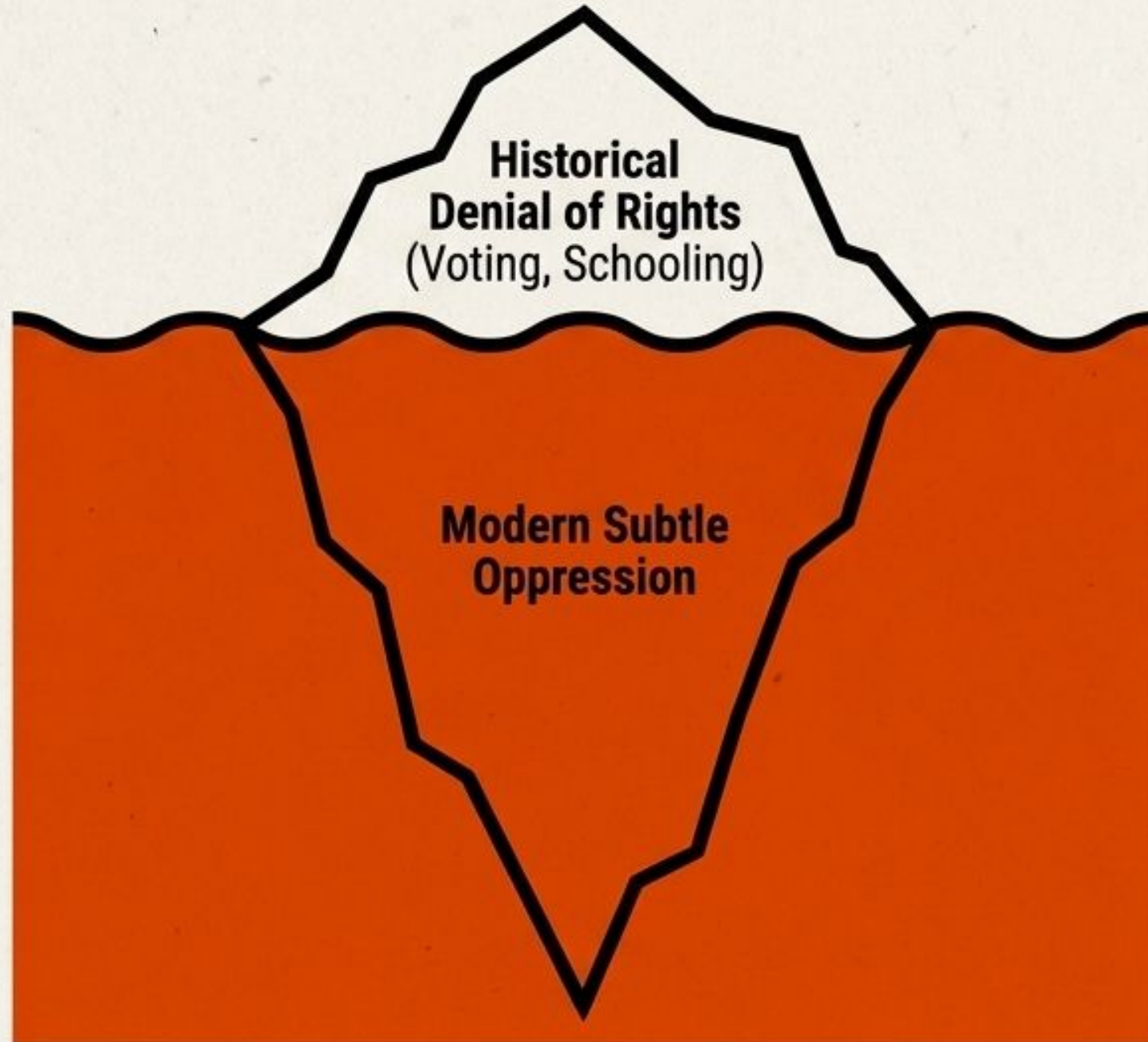


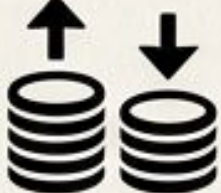
CHINA (The Stringent Rules)

Dictated by Confucianism. Written rules like "Three obediences and four virtues" demanded absolute submission: a woman must obey her father, then her husband, and when widowed, her son.

THE EVOLUTION OF OPPRESSION

Patriarchy hasn't disappeared; it has taken on subtle forms that often go unnoticed.



 Sexism: Prejudice & stereotypes based on sex.	 Pay Gap: Men earning more for the same work.
 Underrepresentation: Lack of women in executive/political power.	 Rape Stigma: Shaming victims instead of perpetrators.
 Behavioral Policing: Conservative expectations on women's behavior.	 Media Hypersexualization: Unrealistic depictions in fiction.
 The Second Shift: Women bearing the brunt of housework/childcare.	 Chore Division: Boys trained as leaders, girls trained for chores.

THE UPRISING: WAVES OF RESISTANCE

1st Wave
(19th - Early 20th C):
The Right to Exist Publicly.
Demanded voting rights
and legal property
ownership.

2nd Wave
(1960s - 1980s):
The Body & Home. Focused
on domestic violence,
marital rape, reproductive
rights, and wage
inequality.

3rd Wave
(1990s):
Intersectionality
& Individualism.

4th Wave
(2012 - Present):
Digital Activism
& systemic
accountability.



**"One is not born, but rather
becomes, a woman." - Simone de
Beauvoir (1949, *The Second Sex*).
Awakened women to their plight as
"wife-servants."**

WHAT THE MOVEMENT DEMANDS

1. Suffrage & Political Equality: Restoring silenced voices. (Fun fact: WWI forced society to drop the 'irrational' stereotype when women ran the home front).

2. Reproductive Rights: Total bodily autonomy. Access to contraception and abortion.

3. Eradication of Domestic Violence: Enforcing laws like RA 9262 and ending the 'away mag-asawa' (just a marital spat) cultural excuse.

4. End to Sexual Violence: Combating the reality that 1 woman/child is raped every hour in the PH, usually by someone they know.

5. Economic Justice: Equitable wages and equal employment opportunities.

6. Legal Freedom: The fundamental right to divorce and make independent life decisions.

THE MACRO REALITY VS. THE MICRO CULTURE

**Women perform 66%
of the world's work &
produce 50% of the food.**

YET:

**They earn 10% of the
income and own 1%
of the property.**

**(Because male heads of family
control agricultural income).**

~~"Babae kase" /
"Lalake kase"~~

~~"Haligi ng tahanan"
vs "Ilaw ng tahanan"~~

~~The "aggressive sperm"
vs the "passive egg"~~

**Actionable Synthesis: Use gender-neutral
language (Humanity > Mankind). Call out
oppressive metaphors.**

KNOWLEDGE UPLOAD COMPLETE (POST-TEST)

**UPLOAD
COMPLETE**

According to Friedrich Engels, what specific human advancement led to the invention of patriarchy?

Contrast ancient Greek and ancient Egyptian views on women's rights regarding property.

What does the Philippine law RA 9262 aim to combat, and what cultural excuse does it challenge?

FIELD ASSESSMENT

TASK 01: VISUAL SYNTHESIS (COLLAGE)

Create a collage showing the progression of human understanding and attitudes toward gender and sexuality in modern societies.



TASK 02: GENERATIONAL AUDIT (INTERVIEWS)

- Interview people from three different age groups (adolescent, adult, elderly).
- Prompt: What do they think of when they hear the words 'gender' and 'sexuality'?
- Follow-up: What influenced them to have these thoughts?



SOURCE CODE [REFERENCES]

Higgins, C. (2018). The age of patriarchy: how an unfashionable idea became a rallying cry for feminism today. The Guardian. Retrieved February 20, 2019.

Kraemer, S. (1991). The origins of the fatherhood: an ancient family process. Wiley Online Library.

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You do not have to be a woman to understand that everyone is free and equal in dignity and in rights.